



A MINNEAPOLIS police officer throws a can of tear gas at protesters on Nicollet Avenue on Saturday.

STEPHEN MATUREN Getty Images

Measles flare-up puts U.S. standing at risk

Panel will decide if country forfeits elimination status amid vaccine gap.

By CORINNE PURTILL

One year ago, a case of measles was recorded in Gaines County, Texas.

It was the start of an outbreak that killed two children and sickened at least 760 people. Thousands more in the U.S. have contracted measles since.

In April, the Pan American Health Organization, an offshoot of the World Health Organization, will determine whether the same virus strain first recorded in west Texas on Jan. 20, 2025, has been transmitted without interruption in the 12 months since.

If it has, the U.S. will officially lose the measles elimination status that the organization conferred in 2000.

Meeting those requirements “took several decades of really hard work,” said Dr. John Swartzberg, an infectious-disease specialist and emeritus professor at UC Berkeley. “Losing that distinction is an embarrassment for the United States. It’s another nail in the coffin for the credibility of this country.”

In public health terms, elimination means that a disease has become rare enough, and immunity to it widespread enough, that local transmission dwindles quickly if a case or two emerges.

Scientists from the U.S. Centers for Disease Control and Prevention are studying virus sequences from multiple sites around the nation to determine whether more recent measles cases are descended from the original outbreak or were introduced from other locations, a distinction that could affect whether the U.S. keeps its status.

Regardless of the international committee’s ultimate ruling, what is clear is that a highly contagious, vaccine-preventable disease [See Measles, A12]

ANALYSIS

United ‘middle powers’ aim to counter Trump

With Greenland emerging as an inflection point, leaders of U.S. allies shed pretense that all is well

By Michael Wilner

NUUK, Greenland — The notion that Denmark alone, or Europe together, could defend Greenland against an American force had become the source of relentless mockery within the White House. The Danish were dismissed as “irrelevant,” while Europe was portrayed as a shadow of its former self. If President Trump chose to take control of this Arctic island, the administration said, it would be his for the taking.

And yet, Europe did defend Greenland last week. Plans for a forceful economic response from the European Union spooked U.S. markets. Trump backed

down from his years-long pursuit to take over the territory — and little Denmark succeeded, securing relief from an American pressure campaign that had challenged its basic sovereignty.

“We’ll get by with a little help from our friends,” Denmark’s prime minister, Mette Frederiksen, wrote in a guest book at Chequers on Thursday, quoting the Beatles while visiting her British counterpart.

The specter of conflict has not disappeared. In Nuuk on Friday, after visiting with local leaders at a government office [See Middle powers, A9]



GINA FERAZZI Los Angeles Times

COLLECTORS and shop owners have been targeted in sometimes violent attacks.

The newest shiny loot? Pokemon

Southland faces rise in heists of prized trading cards

By Salvador Hernandez

Thieves have tried to break into Taylor Minatogawa’s business five times in the last two months, disorienting him so much he’s spent at least a dozen nights inside his shop keeping guard.

A hooded suspect with a baseball bat surprised one of his employees at the door of the Gardena shop during one unsuccessful attempt. In another, thieves cut their way in through the roof, making off with thousands

of dollars’ worth of loot. For all that effort, one might think the store deals in diamonds, designer brands or expensive tech. But Minatogawa doesn’t work with any of those — he deals in Pikachus, Charizards and Jigglypuffs, to name a few.

Over the last six months, trading card shop owners and serious Pokemon card collectors across Southern California have been targeted in brazen, sophis-

ticated and sometimes violent thefts, with losses reaching into the six figures in a single heist.

Police in several cities are investigating. Some are asking neighboring departments if they’ve run into similar cases. For their part, the victims aren’t sure if they’re all being hit by the same crews or different groups targeting the pocket-sized, colorful cartoon loot, or what they and police can [See Pokemon, A12]

Agents’ killing of another protester roils Minneapolis

Video appears to conflict with federal officials’ version of events. Unrest grows.

By JACK BROOK, STEVE KARNOWSKI AND REBECCA SANTANA

MINNEAPOLIS — Federal immigration officers shot and killed a man Saturday in Minneapolis, drawing hundreds of protesters onto frigidly cold streets in a city already shaken by another fatal shooting weeks earlier.

Family members identified the man who was killed as Alex Jeffrey Pretti, a 37-year-old intensive care unit nurse at a Department of Veterans Affairs hospital who had protested President Trump’s immigration crackdown in his city. After the shooting, an angry crowd gathered and protesters clashed with federal immigration officers, who wielded batons and deployed flash-bangs.

The Minnesota National Guard was assisting local police amid growing pro-

tests at the direction of Democratic Gov. Tim Walz, officials said. Guard troops were going to the shooting site and a federal building where officials have squared off with protesters daily.

Information about what led up to the shooting was limited, Minneapolis Police Chief Brian O’Hara said.

Department of Homeland Security spokesperson Tricia McLaughlin said in a statement that federal officers were conducting an operation as part of the Trump administration’s immigration crackdown and fired “defensive shots” after a man with a handgun approached them and “violently resisted” when officers tried to disarm him.

In bystander videos of the shooting that emerged soon after, Pretti is seen with a phone in his hand but none appears to show him with a visible weapon.

O’Hara said police believe the man was a “lawful gun owner with a permit to carry.”

Homeland Security Secretary Kristi Noem said during a news conference later Saturday that Pretti had shown up to “impede a law enforcement operation.” She questioned why he was armed, as she alleged, but did not offer detail about whether Pretti drew a weapon or brandished it at officers.

The officer who shot the man is an eight-year Border [See Shooting, A8]

Corruption case looms over legacy of council member

Curren Price’s court proceeding could influence the L.A. race to replace him.

By JAMES QUEALLY AND NOAH GOLDBERG

Curren Price’s political career appears destined to end before his criminal trial.

Prosecutors first charged the L.A. City Council member in 2023 with embezzlement, perjury and having a conflict of interest in votes on City Council matters in which his wife stood to benefit.

A long-delayed preliminary hearing expected to last several more days, more evidence against Price will be put forth and a judge must decide if prosecutors have

enough evidence to proceed. If it moves forward at the current rate, Price’s case is almost certain to drag on after he is forced from office by term limits at the end of 2026.

Price, 75, is unlikely to face prison time even if convicted — and he is expected to retire from public service at the end of the year after decades as an elected official in Sacramento and Los Angeles.

Some of his colleagues have questioned whether his alleged impropriety should be addressed by the city’s ethics commission rather than a jury.

But with his preliminary hearing expected to last several more days, more evidence against Price is becoming public — meaning the consequences of the case [See Price, A9]

COLUMN ONE

Mexico’s Malinche: From traitor to heroine

By PATRICK J. McDONNELL REPORTING FROM MEXICO CITY

For centuries she was vilified, her name — Malinche — synonymous with deceit and Indigenous collaboration with Hernán Cortés, the Spanish conquistador for whom she served as interpreter, advisor and mistress.

The writer Octavio Paz, the Mexican Nobel laureate, denounced Malinche as a kind of malevolent Eve whose submission to Cortés forever defiled Mexico’s mixed identity.

In the 1980s, outraged residents of the capital’s Coyoacán district forced the removal of a monument to Malinche, Cortés and their son, Martín, who is often called the first *mestizo* (mixed-race) Mexican, though others likely preceded him.

She has long commanded a broad fascination, the subject of paintings, novels, films, songs, operas and TV series. The USS Malinche was a 24th century starship on “Star Trek.”

But now Malinche is experiencing a stunning reassessment, her biography recast as an intrepid feminist survival tale, the [See Malinche, A4]

Winter storm slams the U.S.

Almost 12,000 flights are canceled as snow and ice threaten to knock out power for days and snarl roadways. **NATION, A6**

Adams grateful for a fifth shot

The Rams wide receiver has lost four times in NFC title games, but relishes another try at Super Bowl. **SPORTS, D1**

The little theme park that could

Children’s Fairyland in Oakland, a Disneyland precursor, still charms families after 75 years. **WEEKEND, L6**

Weather

More clouds. L.A. Basin: 70/51. **B8**

